

Swamp Soup

This swamp soup, named for its vibrant green color, is made from a combination of spinach and parsley blended into a silky base, with fiber-rich white beans, shredded chicken and brown rice stirred in for a satisfying texture. A sprinkle of fried garlic and crushed red pepper adds savory crunch and gentle heat to each spoonful.

By **Amanda Holstein** | Published on February 16, 2026

 Reviewed by Dietitian **Emily Lachtrupp, M.S., RD**

Active Time: 25 mins

Total Time: 25 mins

Servings: 4

Nutrition Profile:

Gut Healthy Anti-Inflammatory Mediterranean Diet Sesame-Free Weight Loss Diabetes-Friendly Nut-Free Dairy-Free Healthy Pregnancy Healthy Aging Healthy Immunity Low-Sodium Soy-Free High-Fiber Heart-Healthy Healthy Cholesterol High-Protein Egg-Free Gluten-Free Low-Calorie

Ingredients

- 2 tablespoons extra-virgin olive oil, divided
- 1 medium white onion, chopped
- 1 (1-inch) piece fresh ginger, peeled and chopped
- 3 medium cloves garlic, minced
- 4 cups unsalted chicken broth
- 4 cups baby spinach
- ½ cup coarsely chopped fresh flat-leaf parsley, plus more for garnish
- 1 tablespoon lemon juice
- ½ teaspoon crushed red pepper, plus more for garnish
- ½ teaspoon salt
- ¼ teaspoon ground pepper
- 1 (15-ounce) can no-salt-added white beans, rinsed
- 1 cup shredded cooked chicken breast
- 1 cup cooked long-grain brown rice
- 1 tablespoon fried garlic (such as Maesri) *or* fried onions

Directions

Step 1

Heat 1 tablespoon oil in a large saucepan over medium heat. Add chopped onion, chopped ginger and minced garlic. Cook, stirring constantly, until the onion is softened, about 5 minutes.

Step 2

Add 4 cups broth and bring to a simmer over medium heat. Stir in 4 cups spinach, ½ cup parsley, 1 tablespoon lemon juice, ½ teaspoon crushed red pepper, ½ teaspoon salt and ¼ teaspoon pepper. Cook, stirring occasionally, until the greens are wilted and tender, about 5 minutes.

Step 3

Puree the soup in the saucepan using an immersion blender until smooth, about 2 minutes. *(Alternatively, working in batches, pour the spinach mixture into a blender. Secure the lid and remove the center piece to allow steam to escape. Cover with a clean towel and process until smooth, about 1 minute. Use caution when blending hot liquids.)*

Step 4

Stir in rinsed beans, 1 cup shredded chicken and 1 cup cooked brown rice. Cook over medium heat, stirring occasionally, until the soup is heated through and slightly thickened, about 5 minutes.

Step 5

Divide the soup among 4 bowls. Drizzle with the remaining 1 tablespoon oil and top with 1 tablespoon fried garlic. Garnish with additional parsley and crushed red pepper, if desired.

To make ahead

Refrigerate soup (without toppings) in an airtight container for up to 4 days. Reheat and add toppings just before serving.

Frequently Asked Questions

Can I freeze this soup?



Yes! Allow the finished soup to cool completely, then transfer to a freezer-safe container, leaving an inch of headspace. It can be frozen for up to 3 months. Add the topping right before serving.

Can I use a different green?



Yes. Keep in mind that spinach gives the soup its signature bright green color, so swaps may change the look and flavor slightly. Baby kale, Swiss chard and arugula can all work in place of the spinach. If using sturdier greens (like kale or chard), cook them an extra minute or two before blending to ensure a silky texture.

What do I serve with Swamp Soup?



Serve with a side of crusty whole-wheat bread or a light green salad with a vinaigrette dressing to complete the meal.

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Nutrition Facts

Per serving: **Serving Size 1½ cups** 329 calories; total fat 10g; saturated fat 2g; cholesterol 35mg; sodium 380mg; total carbohydrate 39g; dietary fiber 8g; total sugars 2g; added sugars 0g; protein 23g; vitamin c 21mg; calcium 149mg; iron 5mg; potassium 901mg

Additional reporting by Hilary Meyer *and* Mandy Enright, M.S., RDN, RYT

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